Measuring antisemitism in online discourse

Kornstein Lab for Antisemitism Research

Abstract

This proposed study develops quantitative measures of antisemitism in online discourse, accounting for contextual meaning, classification uncertainty, and differences across sampled communities.

1 Introduction

We propose to study how antisemitism is expressed in online discourse. The aim is to develop transparent measures that account for linguistic context, sampling choices, and uncertainty in reviewed classifications.

2 Measurement framework

An illustrative weighted proportion for a defined corpus is

$$\widehat{p} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i y_i}{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i}.$$

Here, y_i denotes a reviewed classification and w_i a sampling weight. This estimand concerns the sampled corpus, not population prevalence. We would report uncertainty alongside each estimate.

3 Proposed methodology

1. Corpus design and sampling.
2. Contextual annotation.
3. Uncertainty and sensitivity analysis.

4 Limitations

Platform coverage, ambiguous language, and annotation disagreement may affect estimates. The proposal does not establish observed prevalence or causal explanations; no empirical results are reported here.